deliver to it the legal mechanism it needed to hang Bhagat Singh, then it would resort to ministerial action, and this would be the governor-general's ordinance, which would be as good as a statute. A bare semblance of legality was all that was needed. As the documents of the time make clear, it fooled no one, and not least the lawyers acting for Bhagat Singh. Their dedication and forensic acumen deserve special recognition, especially in legal circles, but have gone completely unrecognized so far. First, however, there needs to be recognition of Bhagat Singh as a freedom fighter central to India's Independence Movement and not marginalized to eke out a shadowy existence on the periphery.